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Trump extends ceasefire with Iran

President awaiting Tehran proposal as new talks uncertain

By Munir Ahmed, Jon Gambrell and Matthew Lee
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ISLAMABAD — President Donald Trump said Tuesday the United States was indefinitely extending its ceasefire with Iran — a day before it was to expire — as a new round of peace talks was on hold. The announcement appeared to ease fears that the fighting, which

had shaken energy markets and the global economy, would promptly resume.

Pakistan had planned to host a second round of talks, but the White House put on hold Vice President JD Vance's planned trip to Islamabad as Iran rebuffed efforts to restart negotiations.

Pakistani leaders, including Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, worked intensively late Tuesday to

get both sides to agree to a second round of ceasefire talks, according to two officials who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak to the media.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei told Iran's state TV there has been "no final decision" on whether to attend because of "unacceptable actions" by the U.S., apparently referencing

its recent blockade in the Strait of Hormuz.

As Vance put on hold a return trip to Islamabad, Pakistan's capital, Trump's special envoy Steve Witkoff and son-in-law Jared Kushner were expected in Washington on Tuesday afternoon for consultations about how to proceed, said a U.S. official who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss internal administration deliberations.

The official said Trump has options short of restarting airstrikes. The ceasefire with Iran

began April 8.

A senior commander in Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps threatened to destroy the region's oil industry if war with the United States resumes.

"If southern neighbors allow the enemy to use their facilities to attack Iran, they should say goodbye to oil production in the Middle East region," Gen. Majid Mousavi told an Iranian news site.

Iran's envoy to the United

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A person walks past a restaurant displaying Chicago Bears logos at 1718 W. Northwest Highway, across the road from the former Arlington International Racecourse in Arlington Heights on Tuesday. The former racetrack is the possible future site of a new stadium for the Chicago Bears. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Poll: Chicagoans want Bears in Arlington Heights, not Indiana

56% of respondents rather team move to the northwest suburb, 10% prefer Hoosier State

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

When Brad DeFabo Akin was growing up in Arlington Heights, the first videocassette he owned as a child was "The Super Bowl Shuffle," the Chicago Bears' kitschy song-and-dance classic from 1985.

So if the team were to move to the northwest suburb, it would feel for him like they were staying at home. If they moved to Hammond, Indiana, however, he would likely hold a grudge against them.

"It would be a bummer," said DeFabo Akin, who now lives in Chicago. "That would make most

people angry if they move to Indiana but still call themselves the Chicago Bears."

DeFabo Akin's thoughts about the Bears' potential move reflect how the majority of Chicagoans feel, a new poll found. In a poll conducted by Suffolk University in Boston, 56% of respondents said they would rather see the team move to Arlington Heights, compared with 10% who would prefer Indiana. Another 26% said they didn't care either way.

The poll has a margin of error of plus or minus 4.4 percentage points.

If the Bears move to Hammond, a surprisingly low 38% said they

MORE COVERAGE: Illinois House Democrats push Bears stadium tax deal as Republicans seek property tax relief. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

would still support the franchise, while 15% claimed they would switch their allegiance to another team.

The poll surveyed 500 Chicago adults between April 11 and 15. Of those questioned, 35% of respondents identified as white, 28% Black, 29% Latino and 3% Asian. Almost half described themselves as Democrats, while 34% said they were independent and 9% Republican.

DeFabo Akin, who participated

in the poll, said he wouldn't be personally affected by the move because he doesn't normally go to Bears games. But he still wishes they would stay at Soldier Field in Chicago as he considers it a matter of civic pride.

"Either way," he said, "I will miss having the Bears right here."

The survey's findings revealed some interesting facts about Chicagoans and the Bears, as the issue of the NFL team's future home plays out in both Springfield and Indianapolis.

Along with the quarter of city residents who who don't care

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State gives \$32M to cannabis companies

Some say it's significant move while others call it too little too late

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Illinois officials plan to award almost \$32 million to licensed cannabis companies, in what some business owners said was a significant move, while others questioned whether it was too little too late to save the startups.

"It's very exciting," said Edie Moore, co-founder of Chicago NORML and of SWAY dispensary in Lakeview, which applied for a loan. "I think it's significant. It's across all license types, so everybody who's eligible hopefully will have a piece of that pie."

The loans to 95 licensees were announced Monday, and "may be up to 100% forgivable upon providing documentation for eligible business expenses." That means the companies likely won't have to pay the money back.

Some companies were approved to receive multiple loans. Botavi Wellness, LLC, which operates Nirvana dispensaries, was in line to get five, while Blounts&Moore LLC, operating as Market 96, was to get four.

The amounts awarded range from \$50,000 per company for transporters, to \$245,000 each for dispensaries and infusers, to \$750,000 for craft growers. In total, craft growers were in line to receive almost \$19 million, followed by dispensaries with \$9 million, \$3 million for infusers and \$1 million for transporters.

Those amounts are just a fraction of the cost of opening a dispensary or grow operation, which can reach millions of dollars. But the loans are crucial in a business that remains federally illegal, making most federally insured banks unwilling to participate, resulting in very high interest rates from other lenders, along with more restrictive zoning and higher land costs.

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INSIDE



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Donovan steps down as Bulls head coach

The Bulls will move forward without Billy Donovan, as the coach decided Tuesday to step down from the team after six seasons. His decision came nine days after the Bulls finished the season with a 31-51 record. **Sports**

Students help bring solar energy to their school

Panel installation focus of internship at Carver Military Academy

By Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The two teens huddled around their science teacher, eyes wide as he held a tiny solar panel beneath a fluorescent lamp. As light glinted off the device, a miniature, solar-powered fan whirled to life.

"This mimics the heat of the sun, and we can use it to generate electricity," said Jamiu Sokoya, a physics and environmental science teacher at Carver Military Academy.

The demonstration is just a small-scale preview of the project the students will tackle this

summer.

Juniors LaShawn Jones, 16, and Sebastian Rojas, 17, have been selected for Carver's first green jobs pathway program — a paid, two-month internship focused on installing solar panels at their high school. Alongside four other students, they'll help design and build renewable energy systems on campus.

"It's a great opportunity. Great experience," Jones said. "I feel like not a lot of opportunities come up like this, around this area. It's a blessing."

The initiative is part of the Healthy Green Schools Pilot Program, which allocated \$10 million for clean energy projects across Chicago Public Schools.

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Science teacher Jamiu Sokoya, right, along with his students Sebastian Rojas, 17, left, and LaShawn Jones, 16, use a lamp to mimic the sun to show how electrical power is generated using solar panels at Carver Military Academy on Monday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

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